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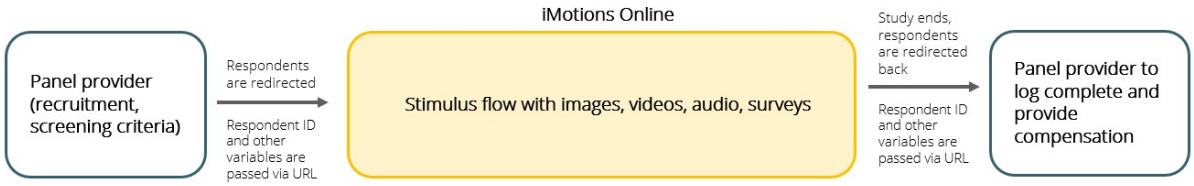
Using iMotions Online with a panel provider

This article covers information related to using a panel provider with iMotions Online.

Introduction

Often, studies with iMotions Online need to be embedded into a wider experimental workflow with other platforms. We see this most frequently with participant recruitment sites or panel providers such as Forsta, Prolific, Qualtrics, CINT, Amazon mTurk, or Sona Systems. Typically, a panel provider will handle the recruitment of respondents and then will forward an iMotions study URL to the respondents who have passed the screening criteria. After the respondents are finished with the iMotions study, they are usually redirected to an outside URL to log completes and/or provide compensation.

For this workflow to be successful, iMotions Online must "handshake" with the panel provider such that information on each participant is passed from one platform to another. One such example is the passthrough of respondent IDs, as described in the figure below.



iMotions Online allows cross-communication with external websites using the HTTP GET method. Cross communications with iMotions Online can occur in two manners:

1. Receiving from an external site: If HTTP GET requests are added by a panel provider onto the end of an iMotions study link, iMotions can parse these requests. Parameters sent to iMotions via the iMotions study link are stored and propagated forward to any websites visited during the study or redirected to once the study has been completed.
2. Sending iMotions-specific information externally: iMotions has its metadata (iMotions Respondent ID, iMotions Study Name, iMotions Stimulus Name) that can be sent externally, as well as any additional queries that are sent to iMotions (see the previous point). These queries can be sent to any websites that are accessed during the study or after the study. The HTTP GET requests are automatically appended to the end of any website addressed being tested in iMotions but must be queried in a specific way for a redirect link. The table below has a list of common

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iMotions-specific tokens that can be appended to URLs:

Token	Replacement value
${studyId}	Study database ID.
${respondentId}	Respondent database ID.
${respondentLabel}	Respondent label (i.e. what you can see in the UI or test plan). E.g. the redirect URL https://example.com?resp=${respondentLabel} would redirect the respondent named RESP0005 to https://example.com?resp=RESP0005
${query}	Parameters from the end of the Cloud URL: https://my.imotions.com/collect/#s/12345panel=67890&rid=384873 Having the redirect URL configured to https://example.com?**${query}**would redirect that respondent to https://example.com with the following variables passed along:panel=67890andrid=384873 NOTE: Make sure that the “?” and parameters are placed after everything else in the data collection URL & the redirect URL. If the data collection URL contains already the "?", append a "&" instead of a second "?".

Using HTTP GET Method

HTTP GET Method depends on queries appended to the end of a URL in a specific manner.



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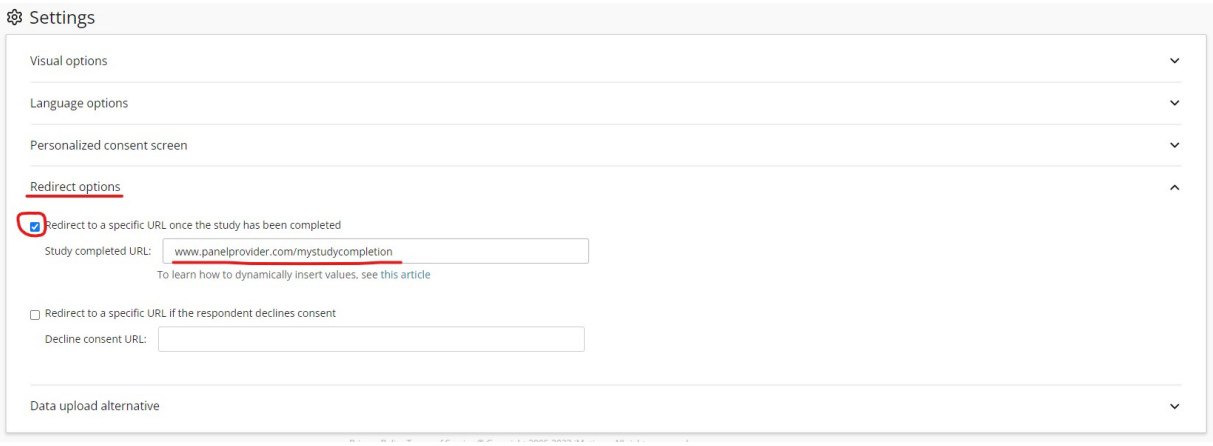
In the above example, there are two variables (with their values) appended at the end of an iMotions study URL. The variables and their values are packed into a query string initiated by "**?**" with each variable linked to its value using "=". Different variables are differentiated by "&". For HTTP GET, you can have as many variables appended to a URL as you desire. The website that you are sending these variable/value pairs must have the ability to parse these queries in order to read and save them. For instance, in Qualtrics, you can create Embedded Data to parse HTTP GET requests as long as the variable names match (capitalization matters).

Some things to consider about HTTP GET method (from https://www.w3schools.com/tags/ref_httpmethods.asp):

1. GET requests can be cached
2. GET requests remain in the browser history
3. GET requests can be bookmarked
4. GET requests should never be used when dealing with sensitive data
5. GET requests have length restrictions
6. GET requests are only used to request data (not modify)

Redirecting Participants Post-Study with HTTP GET Requests

You can add redirect URLs in the Data Collection panel, under "Settings". You have the option of putting a redirect URL when participants finish the study (for example, to a compensation page), or putting a redirect URL if participants decline your study.

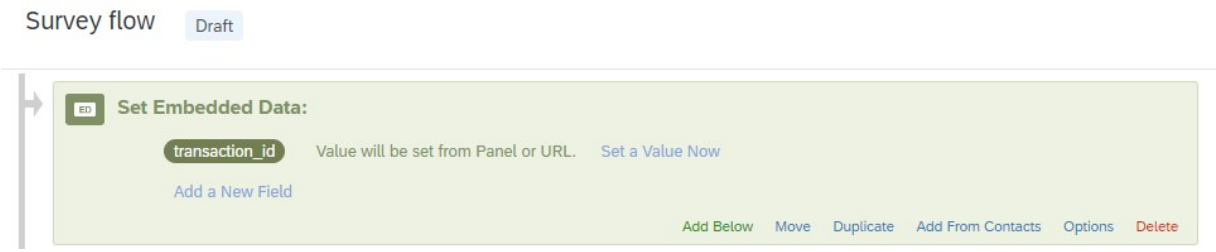


iMotions will automatically append any query parameters that were given before the study. If we use the above example, if respondents enter the iMotions study with the HTTP GET queries "subjectID=Jessica&favoritefood=noodles", once the respondent is done with the iMotions study they will automatically be redirected to "www.panelprovider.com/mystudycompletion?subjectID=Jessica&favoritefood=noodles".

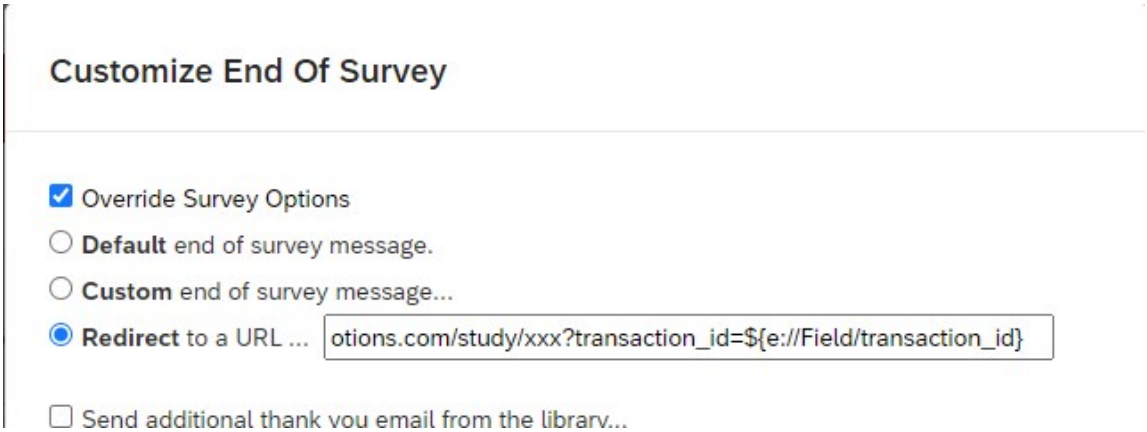
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An Example Using Qualtrics

Imagine I am running an iMotions study and using a panel provider. This provider must first screen potential respondents using a questionnaire I have built using Qualtrics. For each respondent who does the Qualtrics survey, the panel provider will usually provide an ID number so they know which respondents were successfully screened and who successfully finished the study so they can be compensated. Here, this variable is called "transaction_id", which the panel has appended to the screening survey URL. In the Qualtrics Study Flow, the transaction_id variable is shown as an embedded data field so Qualtrics knows to parse this variable from the URL and save it - we will be querying this variable later.



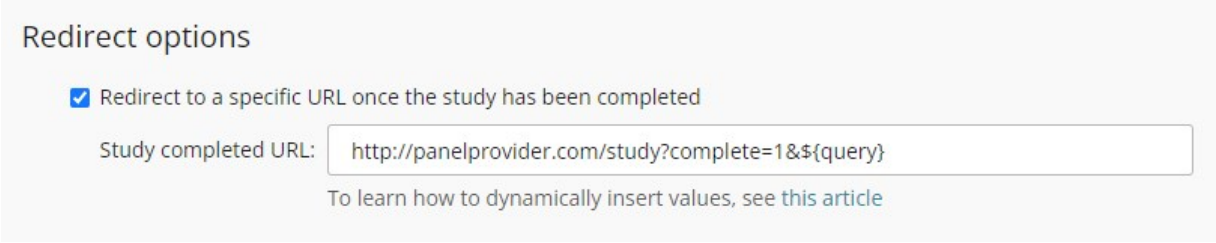
At the end of the Qualtrics survey I add some branch logic that says for each person who passes the screening criteria, they are sent to an "End of Survey" block. I select "Customize" in the block, check "Override Survey Options", and select "Redirect to a URL". In this field, I put in the URL of my iMotions study. Since "transaction_id" is a Qualtrics embedded data field, we use Qualtrics' syntax for calling embedded data (${e://Field/transaction_id}). However, like other HTTP GET queries described above, you can see that the query begins with a "?".



This step facilitates the handshake from Qualtrics to iMotions Online. Next, we want to facilitate the handshake from iMotions Online back out to the panel provider.

In my iMotions Online study, in the Data Collection panel under "Settings", I set the redirect URL as the URL given to me by the panel provider to log completes. In this case, the panel provider has added another variable to log the respondent's completion status (complete=1), and has appended the token ${query} to pass through any other variables that were appended through the course of the study, including the transaction_id variable.

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Thus, the path from the Qualtrics survey, to iMotions Online, and back out again to the panel provider, has been established. If a hypothetical respondent is recruited by the panel provider, and given the ID number "88888", that respondent's journey would be as follows:

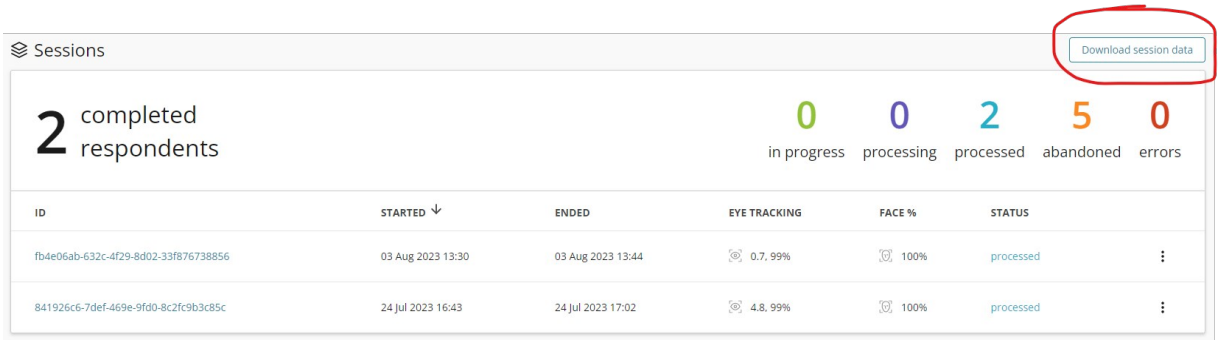
1. Sent to the Qualtrics survey: www.qualtrics.com/survey&transaction_id=88888
2. Respondent completes the Qualtrics survey, passes the screening criteria, and is redirected to the iMotions Online study at http://my.imotions.com/study/xxx?transaction_id=88888
3. Respondent completes the iMotions Online study and is redirected to http://panelprovider.com/study?complete=1&transaction_id=88888

Due to the nature of HTTP GET, the browser knows to append "88888" to all instances where transaction_id is queried because it was initially defined in the first Qualtrics URL and passed through to subsequent URLs.

We advise you to work with your panel provider to determine what variables they provide, what variables must be passed through, and how those variables are called in their specific platform.

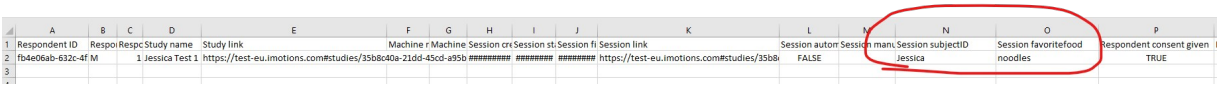
Accessing HTTP GET Data In Exports

By default, iMotions Online provides its own Respondent IDs to participants, often a long string of letters and numbers. It is often necessary to compare a respondent's iMotions ID to other ID variables they have so you know which data belongs to whom. Your respondents' HTTP GET query data can be found in the Data Collection tab under "Sessions". Click on the "Download session data" in the top right corner to download your respondent data in a .csv file.



The .csv export will contain columns for each one of your query variables.

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	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P
1	Respondent ID	Respoi	Respc	Study name	Study link	Machine r	Machine	Session cre	Session st	Session fi	Session link	Session autom	Session man	Session subjectID	Session favoritefood	Respondent consent given
2	fb4e06ab-632c-4f	M	1	Jessica Test 1	https://test-eu.imotions.com#studies/35b8c40a-21dd-45cd-a95b	########	########	########	########	########	https://test-eu.imotions.com#studies/35b8	FALSE		Jessica	noodles	TRUE
3																

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